

use the word ‘megapixel’ anywhere. It was the first time most people had heard that word and hardly knew what it meant (that continues till today but that’s what we are here to change). It dominated everything that was out there by sheer number. Suddenly, everyone wanted a phone with a 1 megapixel camera. After all, it sounded so impressive. And that’s basically how the megapixel war was kicked off.

Not willing to let Nokia take away its glory, Sony Ericsson retaliated with the S700i that had a 1.3 megapixel camera. As was usual back then, Sony Ericsson actually had a better camera phone at its hands but Nokia was a much bigger brand so no one really cared about the S700i and later when Nokia released the 6630 that too had a 1.3 megapixel sensor, it was once again the market leader.

2005 saw the release of phones with front facing cameras, which are all the rage these days. Nokia had its 6680 and Sony Ericsson its K600. Before this, phones used to have a tiny convex mirror next to the rear camera to help you frame yourself to take a self portrait (or “selfie”, as it is now rather annoyingly called these days) but these phones changed that. Sure, the front camera quality was even more abysmal than the rear cameras of older phones but once again it was something new and exciting and something people wanted. (They were really meant to be used for video calling but no one ever used that.)

We eventually reached the 2 megapixel milestone, courtesy of the Sony Ericsson Cyber-shot K750i and Nokia N90. Now we were deeply into the really good quality camera stuff. Both these phones were very good, even by today’s standards. We are talking features like auto-focus, LED flash, dedicated shutter keys, and even Carl Zeiss optics on the N90. The N90 also had VGA resolution video recording, which was



SE K750